

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 34

Group 34 Vocabulary

1. Abrasive

Meaning: Harsh, rough, or irritating in manner.

Tip to remember: Abrasive paper, like sandpaper, scratches surfaces. An abrasive person scratches people's feelings.

Sentence: His abrasive tone made the discussion uncomfortable.

2. Artful

Meaning: Clever or skillful, sometimes in a deceptive way.

Tip to remember: Artful contains "art." It means using skill like an artist, but sometimes to trick people.

Sentence: The lawyer gave an artful argument that impressed the jury.

3. Avert

Meaning: To prevent something bad from happening; to turn away.

Tip to remember: Avert sounds like "avoid." If you avert danger, you avoid it before it happens.

Sentence: Careful planning helped avert a serious accident.

4. Avid

Meaning: Very eager, enthusiastic, or interested.

Tip to remember: Avid sounds like "I want it." An avid learner strongly wants knowledge.

Sentence: He is an avid reader of science books.

5. Brevity

Meaning: Shortness or conciseness in speech or writing.

Tip to remember: Brevity sounds like brief. Brevity means being brief.

Sentence: The teacher appreciated the brevity of her answer.

6. Bromide

Meaning: A boring, overused, or unoriginal statement.

Tip to remember: Think of advice like "work hard and succeed" repeated so often that it becomes dull. That is a bromide.

Sentence: The speech was full of bromides about honesty and discipline.

7. **Circumstantial**
Meaning: Based on indirect evidence or specific circumstances.
Tip to remember: Circumstantial evidence surrounds the fact but does not directly prove it.
Sentence: The case relied mostly on circumstantial evidence.
8. **Cloying**
Meaning: Too sweet or sentimental, often in an unpleasant way.
Tip to remember: Think of a dessert so sweet that it becomes disgusting. That is cloying.
Sentence: The movie's cloying romance felt unrealistic.
9. **Counterfeit**
Meaning: Fake or made to look like the real thing.
Tip to remember: Counterfeit money looks real but is fake.
Sentence: The shopkeeper refused to accept the counterfeit note.
10. **Denigrate**
Meaning: To criticize unfairly or damage someone's reputation.
Tip to remember: Denigrate sounds like "degrade." If you denigrate someone, you degrade their image.
Sentence: He tried to denigrate his rival's achievements.
11. **Disciple**
Meaning: A follower or student of a teacher, leader, or belief.
Tip to remember: Disciple sounds like discipline; a disciple follows the discipline of a teacher.
Sentence: The scientist's disciples continued his research.
12. **Extol**
Meaning: To praise highly.
Tip to remember: Extol sounds like "extra toll of praise." To extol is to give extra praise.
Sentence: The professor extolled the student's original thinking.
13. **Forebode**
Meaning: To warn or indicate that something bad may happen.
Tip to remember: "Fore" means before. Forebode means to sense trouble before it happens.
Sentence: The dark sky seemed to forebode a storm.
14. **Ideologue**
Meaning: A person who strongly follows a particular ideology, often rigidly.
Tip to remember: Ideologue contains idea. An ideologue is controlled by one set of ideas.
Sentence: The ideologue refused to consider evidence against his beliefs.

15. **Impediment**
Meaning: An obstacle or barrier that slows progress.
Tip to remember: Impediment comes from impede, meaning block or slow down.
Sentence: Lack of funding was a major impediment to the project.
16. **Imperative**
Meaning: Extremely important or necessary; also, a command.
Tip to remember: Think of an emergency instruction: “Do this now!” That is imperative.
Sentence: It is imperative to check the data before drawing conclusions.
17. **Impulsive**
Meaning: Acting suddenly without thinking carefully.
Tip to remember: Impulsive comes from impulse. An impulsive person follows sudden urges.
Sentence: His impulsive decision caused many problems.
18. **Interminable**
Meaning: Seeming endless or lasting too long.
Tip to remember: Terminal means end. Interminable means having no visible end.
Sentence: The interminable lecture made the students tired.
19. **Intuitive**
Meaning: Understood naturally without conscious reasoning.
Tip to remember: Intuitive comes from intuition, your inner sense or natural understanding.
Sentence: The software has an intuitive design that beginners can use easily.
20. **Lassitude**
Meaning: Physical or mental tiredness; lack of energy.
Tip to remember: Lassitude sounds like “last attitude” after exhaustion: no energy left.
Sentence: The long summer heat filled everyone with lassitude.
21. **Omit**
Meaning: To leave out or exclude.
Tip to remember: Omit sounds like “out-mit.” If you omit something, you leave it out.
Sentence: Do not omit important evidence from your essay.
22. **Ornate**
Meaning: Highly decorated or elaborate.
Tip to remember: Ornate sounds like ornament. Something ornate has many ornaments.
Sentence: The temple had an ornate wooden doorway.
23. **Paltry**
Meaning: Very small, worthless, or insignificant.

Tip to remember: Paltry sounds like “poorly.” A paltry amount is poor and too little.

Sentence: The workers were unhappy with the paltry wage increase.

24. **Pejorative**

Meaning: Expressing criticism, insult, or negative judgment.

Tip to remember: Pejorative sounds like “poor judgment.” A pejorative word judges someone negatively.

Sentence: The term was used in a pejorative sense.

25. **Prefigure**

Meaning: To represent or suggest something before it happens.

Tip to remember: “Pre” means before. Prefigure means to show the figure of something before it appears fully.

Sentence: Early failures prefigured the company’s later collapse.

26. **Presage**

Meaning: To indicate or warn that something will happen in the future.

Tip to remember: Presage is like a prediction sign. Dark clouds presage rain.

Sentence: The sudden drop in demand presaged an economic slowdown.

27. **Prescribe**

Meaning: To recommend or order officially, especially medicine or rules.

Tip to remember: Doctors prescribe medicine; rules prescribe behavior.

Sentence: The doctor prescribed rest and medicine.

28. **Prevail**

Meaning: To win, succeed, or be widespread.

Tip to remember: Prevail sounds like “prove and win.” If you prevail, you succeed after struggle.

Sentence: Truth eventually prevailed over false claims.

29. **Propitiate**

Meaning: To calm or satisfy someone, especially by pleasing them.

Tip to remember: Propitiate sounds like “please to pacify.” It means to appease.

Sentence: The leader tried to propitiate the angry crowd with promises.

30. **Recapitulate**

Meaning: To summarize or repeat the main points.

Tip to remember: Recapitulate sounds like “re-cap.” At the end, you recap the main ideas.

Sentence: The teacher recapitulated the lesson before ending the class.